

Natural selection.

There is variation in traits. For example, some beetles are pale and others dark.

There is differential reproduction. No environment can support unlimited population growth, so some individuals lose out. Here, birds eat the pale beetles, so fewer of them reproduce.

There is heredity. The dark beetles have more dark offspring because this trait has a genetic basis.

End result: If darkness is the winning trait, producing more offspring, in time, all beetles will be dark.

BACK TO ARTICLE